

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 6 2
 ♥ Q 2
 ♦ 10 5 3 2
 ♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ 9 7

♥ A K 9 6

♦ A Q 9 7 4

♣ A 5



♠ 8 5 4

♥ J 4 3

♦ J 8 6

♣ 10 9 8 2

♠ A K Q J 3

♥ 10 8 7 5

♦ K

♣ K Q J

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♦
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

Lead: ♠4

Your 2♥ bid is a Reverse, showing 17+ points.

There has been no agreement on trumps, so you assume that South has implicitly agreed to ♥s. So you respond 5♣, showing 4 Key-Cards, three Aces and the ♥K. Partner next bids 5♦.

5♦ is the Queen Ask. Partner obviously is thinking about a Grand Slam and wants to know whether you hold the trump Queen (♥Q). Since you do not have the card you return to the agreed trump suit at the lowest level - which is 5♥. Partner now bids 6♥.

Board 2

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 4
♥ 10 4 2
♦ 2
♣ J 10 9 7 5

♠ A 6 3

♥ A K 9 8 6 5

♦ K

♣ A 3 2



♠ Q J 5 2

♥ 7

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ Q 8 6 4

♠ K 7

♥ Q J 3

♦ A Q J 10 8 7 5

♣ K

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♣	Pass	5NT
Pass	6 ♦	Pass	7NT

All Pass

7NT by South

Lead: ♣J

The bidding has been as shown. Yes, you could have jump-shifted on your first bid.

Slam in ♥s is almost certain, but you should check for Key-Cards. You bid 4NT and partner says 5 ♣.

Partner shows 1 or 4 Key-cards. Since he jumped on the second round you figure it must be 4. So you have all the Key-Cards. Time to find out about the other Kings, so you bid 5NT. Partner replies 6 ♦.

Partner has 1 King, the only one left, the ♦K. You can count about 17 high-card tricks available so you bid 7NT.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 9 5 4 2

♥ 5 2

♦ 9 8

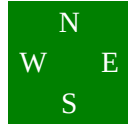
♣ 7 5 2

♠ 10 8 6

♥ K Q J 8 3

♦ 10

♣ A K Q 6



♠ K Q 7 3

♥ 7 4

♦ A 6 5 3 2

♣ 9 4

♠ —

♥ A 10 9 6

♦ K Q J 7 4

♣ J 10 8 3

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

3♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

Lead: ♠K

Your 3♠ bid is a Splinter, agreeing ♥s as trump, and showing opening hand strength with a singleton or void in ♠s.

You have one Key-Card, the ♥A. You also have a ♠ void, but since bidding 6♠ would take you above the 6♥ level you just respond 6♥. Partner will deduce that your void is in ♠s, particularly because you Splintered in that suit. Partner passes your 6♥ bid.

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
 ♥ 9 5 3 2
 ♦ A Q J 10 4
 ♣ Q 9 8

♠ A 10 8 4 3

♥ Q 10 8 4

♦ —

♣ K J 10 2



♠ 7

♥ J 7 6

♦ K 9 6 3 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ K Q J 9 6 5

♥ A K

♦ 8 7 5

♣ A 5

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	6 ♦	Pass	7 ♠
All Pass			
7 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♥ 3			

Partner's 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least 4-card ♠ support, and a singleton or void in ♦s.

Normally you would not ask for Key-Cards with this ♦ holding. But since you know partner has at most a singleton, and that it is not the singleton ♦ A, you are safe to do so. You say 4NT, partner replies 6♦. What next?

WOW! Partner has one Key-Card and a ♦ void. So the Key-Card is the ♠ A. You don't know what the rest of partner's hand is, but he can surely take care of that small ♣. You bid 7♠.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 6 2

♥ J 9 5 3

♦ 5 2

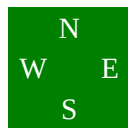
♣ 4 3 2

♠ K 8 7

♥ A 10 6

♦ Q 9 7 4

♣ J 10 8



♠ 10 4 3

♥ K Q 8 7 2

♦ J

♣ 9 7 6 5

♠ A Q 5

♥ 4

♦ A K 10 8 6 3

♣ A K Q

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♥
Pass	5♠	Pass	7NT

All Pass

7NT by North

Lead: ♥K

Your 2NT response shows 8+ points, with no 5-card biddable suit.

You support the ♦s and partner bids 4NT. What is your next bid?

With ♦s as trump you have 1 Key-Card, the ♥A. You answer 5♣ and partner bids 5♥. What is your bid?

This is the Queen Ask, wanting to know if you hold the ♦Q. Since you do have it you should bid a suit in which you hold a King. So you bid 5♠. That spurred partner on - he was fishing for 7♦ but when you told him you had the ♦Q, ♥A and ♠K he was able to bid 7NT.

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 9 7 4 3

♥ 4

♦ 10 9 6 2

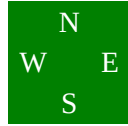
♣ 9 4 3

♠ Q 8

♥ A J 9 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A K Q 6



♠ A K J 6 5 2

♥ 5

♦ A 8 7 4

♣ 7 5

♠ —

♥ K Q 10 8 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ J 10 8 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South

Lead: ♦ 10

Partner's 2♥ is a positive response, 8+ points with a 5+ card suit.

Even though it is tempting, bidding RKCB now would be a mistake because of your doubleton ♠ loser. Instead just support the ♥s. Partner cannot pass, you both know you are forced to game. In fact, partner bids 3♠.

Partner promises first round ♠ control so NOW you can bid RCKB. When you bid 4NT partner answers 6♥. This shows 1 Key-Card and a void in a suit higher than ♥s. Knowing you are missing either the ♦A or ♥K you pass.